

Horn of Africa

Chimpanzee

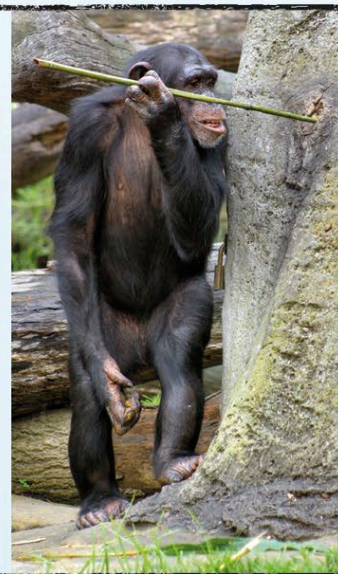
Like other great apes, the chimpanzee walks on its knuckles when on all fours. In the eastern part of its range, it roams central highland forests as high up as 9,155 ft (2,790 m).

Eastern gorilla

Eastern gorillas have thicker, blacker fur than western gorillas. Some live in lowland habitats, but eastern mountain gorillas live at heights of up to 12,470 ft (3,800 m); they are the stockiest, furriest gorillas.

Using tools

Gorillas and bonobos mainly eat plants and fruit, but chimpanzees are more carnivorous, and even use tools to help catch prey or collect food. They use twigs to pull termites from holes, sharpened sticks to spear tiny primates, and stones or clubs to crack nuts. Young chimpanzees watch older ones to learn how it is done.

**Threat display**

Adult male gorillas intimidate rivals by standing upright to look bigger, while rhythmically beating their chest with cupped hands and hooting or roaring loudly. Older males are known as silverbacks.

Male eastern mountain gorilla

Bonobo

Also called the pygmy chimpanzee, the bonobo is more lightly built than the chimpanzee. Its range is separated from that of its bigger cousins, who live on the other side of the great Congo River.

Shrinking habitats

The chimpanzee has the widest range of any great ape and can survive in drier, more open woodland than bonobos and gorillas. But all great ape species are threatened with extinction as the cutting down of rainforest continues to shrink their natural habitats, while poaching kills large numbers every year.

